Ask a question, then collect

Data engineering · Level 1 · Lesson 2



Today we will

- Turn a question into the data we need.
- Plan a tidy collection sheet: columns, units and codes.
- Collect with tally marks, and save the table as CSV.

Remember

- Start with one question.
- Units in the headings, codes agreed, dates one way.
- Collect only what the question needs.

Our class survey

1. Warm-up (5 min): What would we like to know about our class?
2. Plan (10 min): Columns, units and codes.
3. Collect (12 min): Tally the answers.
4. Type (8 min): One row at a time.
5. Wrap-up (5 min): Answer the question.

Choose a question with no sensitive answers: travel time and favourite subject are fine; family income or health are not. Keep the tally sheets until the table has been checked.

Let’s discuss

1. Which data did we decide not to collect, and why?
2. What could go wrong if everyone wrote the minutes their own way?
3. Why save the table as CSV instead of taking a photo of the board?

Exit ticket

- Write one question about our school, and the two columns you would need to answer it.